Japan Portfolio Brief — Wednesday, October 28, 2026

Covers the Oct 27 close to the just-completed Tokyo and Seoul sessions of Wed Oct 28. Positions are treated as live exposure. ***Data-quality warning (same as prior runs):*** *direct page fetches (company IR, TDnet, DART, Kabutan, MOF) failed in the research environment, so everything comes from search-result summaries. Market-level numbers are well sourced;* ***no company-specific news dated Oct 27–28 was found for most names****, so "QUIET" means "searched, nothing found," not "confirmed quiet." Earnings dates are mostly aggregator-sourced (kabuyoho) and unconfirmed. Check TDnet/DART before acting on any single-name call.*

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1. Top of the stack

SK hynix's record Q3 sent KOSPI +6.63% to 6,012 and lifted Tokyo chips; the Nikkei closed at 63,954 (+1.08%) but the breadth was poor. KOSPI closed **6,012.44 (+374.10)**, back above 6,000 for the first time in 10 sessions; KOSDAQ closed **771.28 (+3.69%)** (Newspim, Seoul Shinmun, UPI). Samsung Electronics rose ~9% and SK hynix +10.98% to ₩1,487,000; SK Square +11.23% (Seoul Shinmun, IBTimes AU). In Tokyo the **Nikkei 225 closed +685.82 (+1.08%) at 63,954.19**, a second straight gain, while **TOPIX fell 0.14% to 3,991.71**; 139 Nikkei components fell vs 85 rose, so the index was carried by Kioxia (>+10%), Tokyo Electron (+4%) and Advantest (+3%) (IBTimes AU). An Investing.com print of +1.52% at 64,232 was pre-close and is ignored (Investing.com). Foreign/institutional net buying in Korea was large; retail sold ₩2.33tn (Ajupress; flow figures differ by outlet).

SK hynix Q3 (Oct 28): revenue ₩104.6tn, operating profit ₩83.33tn (~80% margin), ~10% above consensus. Operating profit +632% y/y and +38% q/q vs FnGuide consensus ~₩76tn; net profit ~₩39.8tn (down q/q on non-operating/FX losses; one source says ₩39.5tn); Q3 dividend ₩20,000/share (₩10,000 regular + ₩10,000 special tied to the Kioxia gain) and a further ₩60tn of shareholder returns, taking 2026 to ~₩100tn (SK hynix, Korea Times, Investing.com call transcript). Book read-through: **SK Inc (034730)** is the direct holding-company exposure (price move not verified); Tokyo AI-chain names (Sanken, RS Technologies, MegaChips, SoftBank) are sentiment-linked. **Samsung Electronics reports Oct 29** (prelim Oct 8: ~₩195tn sales, ~₩107.4tn operating profit; consensus ₩105–108tn; ~₩30tn dividend expected) (Segye Biz).

Canon (7751): Q3 confirmed, full-year guidance trimmed ~2%. Reported Oct 27: sales ¥1,158.8bn (+4.9%, Q3 record), operating profit ¥97.1bn (+10.3%), net income ¥75.2bn (+18.2%). Full-year guidance cut: sales ¥4.80tn → ¥4.766tn, operating profit ¥465bn → ¥456bn, on further medical-unit delays and AI-driven component shortages in imaging (Canon results note, Investing.com, The Digital Picture). This resolves yesterday's "unverified" flag. Post-cut net income guidance was not found. A Q3 beat with a small trim: MATTERS, but not a thesis break.

BoJ Oct 29–30 and the JGB position. Hold at 1.25% is consensus (Sept 18 hike to 1.25% was reportedly a 7–2 vote); December hike odds are reported at ~75–88%, with some banks (ING, Standard Chartered) leaning to January (CNBC, Investinglive, Standard Chartered via Mitrade). The 10y JGB was ~2.80% on Oct 26 (no Oct 27–28 print found) (NewsBytes). **JGB No. 466 (JP1024661QB1 position) matures Nov 1 — see Section 4.**

Fed decision (2pm ET Oct 28) fell after the Asian close; outcome not found. Previews expected a hold (~80–90% odds) (Fedratecalc). Sources conflict on the current range (3.75–4.00% vs 3.50–3.75%), so treat the level as unverified.

2. What matters, by theme

Macro, rates, FX

- **BoJ:** see Top of the stack. Focus on the Outlook Report (FY2027 inflation forecast may rise; Sept core CPI was 2.1% per a secondary source) and whether the "underlying inflation nearing 2%" language changes (Investinglive). Ueda said mid-October the BoJ would "basically continue to raise" rates (wording unverified). A hawkish hold is mildly supportive for banks; a dovish surprise is the risk (our inference).
- **JGBs:** 10y 2.795–2.81% (Oct 26); 2y, 5y and 30y not found; no auction results found this week. PM Takaichi said JGB issuance would be kept "at an appropriate level"; FY2027 budget goes to cabinet at year-end (FXStreet). Cycle peak was 2.97% on Sept 1 (highest since 1996; Reuters via search, no URL).
- **Yen:** USD/JPY ~157–157.7 this week (dates approximate) (Business Recorder). No intervention talk found. Oil/Iran worries are cited as a headwind (Investinglive).
- **Korea:** won closed **1,337.7/USD** (-14.0 vs Oct 27's 1,323.7; weakest since Oct 15) on importer settlement and retail FX buying for overseas stocks (Newsis). Bank of Korea held at 3.00% on Oct 22 after July and August hikes; a November hike is a live debate (iM Securities sees 3.25% in November); next meeting **Nov 26**; Oct CPI due Nov 2 (Kyunghyang, News1).
- **Korea market structure:** the amended Commercial Act (mandatory treasury-share cancellation: new shares within 1 year, existing within 1.5 years of effect, shareholder-approved exceptions; passed 175–0 on Feb 25, 2026) remains the key structural item (Nate News). Effective date/follow-up legislation not verified. No new October value-up or MSCI news found.

Megacaps / tech / electronics

- **Canon, SK hynix:** see Top of the stack.
- **Sony (6758):** QUIET. Last news is the Q1 beat/guidance raise (Jul 31) and Kumamoto earthquake impact assessment (TipRanks). Q2 date not found (likely early Nov, unverified).
- **SoftBank Group (9984):** no new company news found; today's price move not retrieved (it was a high-beta AI proxy in the rally). Carried forward: Oct 26 close ¥4,263, ~36% below the Oct 1 close; ¥5.50 interim dividend approved Oct 23; Q2 results ~**Nov 10** (aggregator). OpenAI-share margin-loan collateral cover remains the question.
- **Keyence (6861):** QUIET; Q2 results listed for **Oct 29** by one calendar, Oct 23 by another (conflict, unverified). Q1 sales ¥346.6bn (+32.8%) (Keyence).
- **Seiko Epson (6724), Omron (6645):** QUIET. Both raised guidance after Q1 (Quartr Omron, Quartr Epson). Q2 dates not found (Epson possibly ~Oct 31, unverified).
- **Optex (6914), Oro (3983), SHIFT (3697), Appier (4180), MegaChips (6875), Sanken (6707), RS Technologies (3445):** QUIET. MegaChips analyst estimates trimmed (Simply Wall St); Appier guides ¥4.32bn recurring profit (+61.5%) (kabuyoho); SHIFT last reported Jul 15. Dates for the next prints unknown.
- **Naver (035420):** QUIET; Q3 previews point to an ~11% operating profit miss (Hanwha) vs ₩533bn (Kyobo) (StockHub); date not found.
- **LG Electronics pref (066575):** Q3 preliminary operating profit ₩781.8bn (+13.5% y/y) on revenue ₩23.83tn, ~~24% below consensus (~~₩925bn) (StockHub, SBS Biz). Release predates the window; NOISE for today but a miss on the book.

Banks / financials / real estate

- **Fidea (8713), Kita-Nippon (8551), Kyoto FG (5844), MUFG (8306), Resona (8308), Shimizu Bank (8364), SMTG (8309), SBI (8473), Japan Post (6178):** all QUIET today. Interim dates (kabuyoho, unconfirmed): SBI

Nov 2; Resona **Nov 10**; Kita-Nippon and SMTG **Nov 12**; Fidea, Kyoto FG, MUFG, Shimizu, Japan Post **Nov 13** (MUFG's date looks late versus its usual early-Nov pattern; verify on IR). Reference: Fidea Q1 recurring profit ¥2.34bn (FY forecast ¥4.8bn) (Monex); Shimizu Bank Q1 ¥2.25bn vs ¥2.4bn interim forecast (Monex); SMTG Q1 recurring profit ¥173.4bn (2.1x) (Matsui). Japan Post: undated TipRanks headlines on buybacks and administrative measures could not be verified (TipRanks).

- **Mitsui Fudosan (8801), TOC (8841), Katakura (3001), Tokyotokeiba (9672), Yakult (2267):** QUIET. Mitsui Fudosan interim **Nov 6** (IRBANK); Yakult "mid-Nov"; TOC, Katakura, Tokyotokeiba dates not found.
- **Shochiku (9601):** QUIET; interim already out Oct 14 (recurring profit ¥3.73bn) (kabuyoho).

Industrials / autos / materials

- **Honda (7267), Suzuki (7269), Subaru (7270):** QUIET. Subaru Q1 operating profit -44.3% to ¥42.6bn (Subaru); Suzuki Q1 figures conflict between sources and a Carview headline reports an FY operating-profit guidance cut on Middle East impact (body unread) (Carview). Subaru's interim is "early Nov" per kabuyoho, but one source says **Oct 30** (unverified; inside the window if true).
- **Hi-Lex (7279):** QUIET; FY ends Oct 31, results ~mid-Dec.
- **Daikin (6367):** QUIET; interim ~**Nov 5** (Q1 ordinary profit ¥120.8bn, slightly light) (Monex).
- **Kubota (6326):** QUIET; FY guidance raised in August plus ¥40bn buyback (Filing Reader).
- **JR Central (9022):** QUIET (unverified); interim likely **Oct 29–30** (last year Oct 29 with a forecast raise) (Filing Reader). **Keisei (9009):** an RTTNews calendar lists an Oct 24 interim but no figures were found; check TDnet (RTTNews).
- **Sumitomo Metal Mining (5713):** QUIET; FY pre-tax forecast was raised to ¥324bn in August (Monex). **Mitsubishi Materials (5711):** QUIET; H2 refined-copper output reportedly cut ~18% on smelter maintenance (aggregate item, unverified) (Stockopedia).
- **Nakayama Steel (5408):** QUIET; Q1 ordinary profit ¥0.61bn (30.5% of forecast); interim **Nov 5** (Matsui).
- **Valqua (7995):** QUIET; FY ordinary profit guide raised to ¥10.8bn in July; interim ~Nov 5 (last-year analogy) (Monex).
- **KH Neochem (4189):** QUIET; interim ordinary profit ¥7.44bn (+29.3%) (kabuyoho); next print early Nov. **Shibaura Machine (6104):** QUIET; Q1 ordinary loss ¥0.26bn, FY forecast -38%; interim ~Nov 11 (analogy) (JPX). **Obara (6877):** QUIET; 82% of FY plan after Q3, FY results ~mid-Nov (Kabutan). **Ebara Jitsugyo (6328):** QUIET; Q3 early Nov (Kabutan). **Fudo Tetra (1813):** QUIET; ~Nov 9 (period labels inconsistent) (kabuyoho). **Tigers Polymer (4231):** QUIET; Nov 11 listing unverified (kabuyoho). **JAPEX (1662), Universal Entertainment (6425):** QUIET; mid-Nov prints. Universal planned a Las Vegas slot-supplier business (Sep 12) (ASGAM).

Korea single names

- **Amorepacific Group (002790):** MATTERS (catalyst): Q3 results **Oct 29** per one source (another shows Nov 4; statutory deadline Nov 16). Q3 2025 baseline: revenue ₩1.108tn, operating profit ₩104.3bn (Vegannews, Herald).
- **LG Chem pref (051915):** MATTERS (risk): Q3 results **Nov 5** 14:00 (Vegannews). A StockHub preview shows Q3 operating profit ~₩17.5bn vs consensus ₩537bn on a naphtha inventory hit; unverified broker-style estimate (StockHub).
- **Taekwang Industrial (003240):** MATTERS, no new item. Truston's Sept 3 open letter set a ~Oct 3 deadline and threatened an EGM request, books inspection and derivative suit; Taekwang filed a police complaint Sept 4. The

₩320bn EB on treasury shares was suspended and injunctions dismissed (Sept 2025); a ~₩300bn treasury-share PRS was explored (execution unconfirmed). Outcome after Oct 3 not found — check DART for an EGM filing (Ajunews, Nate News, SEDaily). The treasury-share cancellation mandate undermines the PRS/EB funding route.

- **Misto Holdings (081660):** NOISE; Q3 dividend ₩960/share (record date Oct 16), targets ≥40% total shareholder return for 2026–27 (IBTomato).
- **F&F (383220):** QUIET; Q2 miss sent shares ~-20% on Aug 3 (MT); Q3 date unconfirmed. **SK Discovery (006120):** QUIET; Q2 operating loss ₩30.4bn (EtfShopping). **LG Corp (003550):** QUIET; LG Electronics miss is a read-through. **LS Corp (006260):** NOISE; LS Electric record Q3 operating profit ₩233.5bn (Oct 21) (Newspim). **Hyosung (004800), ILJIN (015860), Samsung C&T (028260):** QUIET. **SK Inc (034730):** see Top of the stack.
- **Motonic (009680), Seoul City Gas (017390), Samyang Tongsang (002170), Ubiquoss (078070), Daewon Sanup (005710), Eusu (000700):** QUIET. Searched, nothing found (the only Samyang hit was Samyang Holdings 000070, a different company). Q3 dates unconfirmed (deadline ~Nov 16).

3. Probably noise

- **Investing.com Nikkei +1.52% / 64,232** — pre-close print; the close was +1.08% at 63,954.
- **Net profit -58% q/q at SK hynix** — non-operating and FX items; operating line is the signal.
- **LG Electronics Q3 miss and LS Electric record** — both pre-date the window.
- **Keyence "Oct 23" vs "Oct 29"** — conflicting calendars; one is stale.
- **StockWirex ~30% October BoJ hike odds** — undated and contradicted by every dated source.
- **CME "2.50%" for the Bank of Korea** — stale.
- **Aggregator earnings dates generally**, especially for Korean small caps.

4. Time-sensitive / positions watch

JGB JP1024661QB1 — maturing Nov 1; decision needed before it redeems. JGB No. 466 (2-year, 0.50%, coupon dates May 1/Nov 1, issued 2024-11-01) redeems **2026-11-01** per MOF auction records (MOF offer, MOF results, Nagoya SE price table). The ISIN→No. 466 mapping is still inferred (no source returned an ISIN). Nov 1 is a Sunday; payment on Mon Nov 2 is the usual practice but was not verified — confirm with the custodian. Tokyo is closed Tue Nov 3. Reinvestment reference: 10y ~2.80%; 2y/5y/30y not refreshed. BoJ Oct 30 (hold expected, December hike ~75–88% priced) is the key input. `watchlist-japan.md` keeps the line until redemption is confirmed.

*Calendar (= aggregator/unconfirmed):**

- Oct 28 (after Asia close): **FOMC** 2pm ET — outcome not found
- Oct 29: **Samsung Electronics Q3** (final); Amorepacific Group Q3*; Keyence*; JR Central*; BoJ day 1; US Q3 GDP/PCE
- Oct 30: **BoJ decision** (~noon JST) + Outlook Report; Subaru* (unverified, conflicts with early Nov)
- Oct 31: Hi-Lex FY-end; Seiko Epson* (unverified)
- Nov 2: SBI interim*; Korea Oct CPI; JGB redemption/settlement (expected)
- Nov 3: Tokyo closed
- Nov 5: **LG Chem Q3**; Daikin*, Nakayama Steel*, Valqua*; early-Nov cluster: Honda, Suzuki, Kubota, Mitsubishi Materials, KH Neochem, SMM, Ebara Jitsugyo, Sony

- Nov 6: Mitsui Fudosan*; US jobs report
- Nov 9–13: Fudo Tetra* (9); Resona*, SoftBank Group* (10); Shibaura*, Tigers Polymer* (11); SMTG*, Kita-Nippon* (12); MUFG*, Kyoto FG*, Fidea*, Shimizu*, Japan Post* (13)
- Mid-Nov: Universal Entertainment, JAPEX, Obara, Yakult, Appier, Optex, Oro, SK Inc; Korea small caps by Nov 16
- Nov 26: Bank of Korea

Undated-but-live: SoftBank margin-loan/collateral and OpenAI funding; Taekwang–Truston (EGM, treasury shares/PRS); Suzuki possible guidance cut; Universal Entertainment guidance; Kita-Nippon/Shimizu upward-revision potential; yen intervention risk near 160; Korean won weakness (1,338).

Identity/watchlist flags:

1. **8551 vs 8524 — still open for owner.** 8551 = The Kita-Nippon Bank (北日本銀行, Morioka, Iwate; Simply Wall St). 8524 = North Pacific Bank (北洋銀行, Sapporo; ROIC), which matches the owner's original wording; FY recurring profit forecast ¥44.4bn, interim Nov 13. A May 2024 disclosure reportedly mentions Fidea studying an alliance with North Pacific Bank (not opened; EDINET). Please confirm which is held; coverage continues on 8551.
2. **JGB:** maturity MOF-confirmed; ISIN mapping inferred; see above.
3. Canon guidance-cut flag from Oct 27 resolved as real (watchlist unchanged otherwise). No other identity changes.

5. Follow-up questions to investigate

- **JP1024661QB1:** confirm ISIN→No. 466 and Nov 2 payment with the custodian; reinvestment plan relative to the Oct 30 BoJ outcome and a fresh 2y/5y quote.
- **SoftBank (9984):** today's move, margin-loan LTV and any collateral top-up; Q2 date.
- **SK Inc (034730) / Samsung C&T:** did SK hynix's ₩60tn extra return and Kioxia gain flow through to SK Inc's price and NAV discount?
- **Samsung Electronics Oct 29:** does a ~₩107tn print and ~₩30tn dividend change the Samsung C&T outlook?
- **Canon (7751):** post-cut full-year net income guidance; size of medical-unit delay.
- **Taekwang (003240):** any DART filing after the Oct 3 Truston deadline (EGM call, books inspection, PRS execution)?
- **LG Chem pref (051915):** is the ₩17.5bn Q3 operating-profit estimate real vs ₩537bn consensus?
- **Suzuki (7269):** was FY operating profit guidance actually cut, and what are the true Q1 figures?
- **JR Central, Keisei, Subaru, Keyence:** check TDnet for Oct 28–30 releases.
- **MUFG (8306):** confirm interim date (Nov 13 looks late).
- **Fed outcome and BoJ Outlook Report:** refresh in tomorrow's run; also get 2y/5y/30y JGB levels and USD/JPY.
- **Names with no news in 3+ runs:** Ubiquoss, Daewon Sanup, Eusu, Motonic, Seoul City Gas, Katakura, TOC — retry via DART/EDINET directly.